
TOTTENHAM COMMUNITY CHOIR



Welcome Pack

Singing Makes You Feel Good! That's our motto, and every Tuesday evening the members of Tottenham Community Choir put their hearts, souls, and voice boxes into feeling good. We sing a wide selection of music from many countries and many genres, and have lots of opportunities to sing in a real range of venues and interesting events through the year, as well as our regular Tuesday evening rehearsals.

This welcome pack contains general information about the choir to help you settle in.



WHO'S WHO

The choir is run by a voluntary **Committee**, made of up to 10 members from across the choir. There is a Chair, Treasurer, Secretary, Membership and Comms Manager. Our current chair is Oli (tenor). The committee meets about once a month, and an AGM is held each year.

There is a **Performance and Repertoire Committee** (Perf & Rep), made up of members of the choir and the Musical Director. This committee decides what we sing each year, and where we perform. We gather suggestions from the choir annually about music we should perform, as well as commissioning arrangements and taking guidance from the Musical Director.

The **Musical Director** (MD) of the choir is Nicki Williamson, and she has been with the choir since 2011. Our accompanist is Horacio.

Comms about the choir are managed by Angela (alto) and a summary of rehearsals is sent out each week from comms@tottenhamcommunitychoir.org.

The choir is split into four vocal parts Soprano, Alto, Tenor and Bass (SATB). Each section has a **Section Rep**, their role is to welcome new members into their section and have a general overview of the section, liaising with the MD and Committee where appropriate. Current Section Reps are:

Soprano - Anna Shephard

Alto - Maggie Coster

Tenor - Maggie Caird

Bass - Gabe Churchill

Other voluntary roles at choir:

Librarians - these members help with the copying and disseminating of our sheet music

Cake and tearoom - baking cakes for the break and preparing the tearoom

Preparing the rehearsal room - putting out registers, chairs, piano, music stand, MDs table etc.

Closing the rehearsal room - put away piano, music stand, table, (Chestnuts staff clear chairs)

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Singing with us

Rehearsals

There are three terms a year, with breaks that broadly follow the school terms.

Time: Every Tuesday from 7.30 - 9.30pm

Venue: Chestnuts Community Centre, 280 St Ann's Road, London, N15 5BN

Nearest Tube Stations: Seven Sisters (Victoria Line) & Turnpike Lane (Piccadilly Line)

Local Buses: 67, 41, 341

Please arrive in time to start at 7.30, and sign in at the registration form by the door. We ask that you NOT attend if you are feeling unwell.

If you are cycling, you can leave your bike in the break room.

Choir starts with a warm up led by Nicki, then we usually focus on one piece before the break at 8.30pm (10 minutes), then another piece after the break.

In the break, a hot drink and piece of cake are available at 50p each, but please bring your own mug.

Music sheets can be found on the table at the back of the rehearsal room.

Learning the pieces

TCC is open to everyone, whether you can read music or not. When we perform, we do so without our music sheets, which helps us follow Nicki's conducting and know the pieces inside out. In order to help with practice, Horacio records each part as a music track. These are called **midis**, and can be found on the members area of the website under [Repertoire](#). It's really helpful to listen to these tracks between rehearsals, so you get to learn the geography of the piece. There is also an [app available](#) which loops the pieces.

Concerts

We have one dedicated concert a year, usually in November, in a local venue. We sell tickets and refreshments, and raise money for a local charity.

There are other performance opportunities throughout the year at community events, which will be communicated to the choir.

Concert dress code: Our colours are black and purple (or shades of purple such as mauve and lilac). See the [dress code section](#) of the members area for more information.

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Singing tips

Practice, practice, practice!

Make use of the midi files for each song found in the members section.

Bring a pencil with you to make notes on your sheet music.

It can be helpful to put your sheet music in a folder so it is easier to turn between pages.

Hot drinks can help soothe your vocal cords.

FEES

How much does it cost?

Our membership fees, payable each term (approx. 13 weeks) are as follows:

- £65.00/term working full-time
- £45.00/term retired or working part-time
- £20.00/term student or working-age unemployed

You can add £15 to your fees to cover interval refreshments throughout the term or pay in cash each week (more info below)

How do I pay my fees?

You can pay by bank transfer to the account details below or you can pay by card, cash or cheque at a choir rehearsal.

Name: Tottenham Community Choir

Sort code: 20-53-00

Account no.: 03486109

Barclays Bank

GENERAL INFORMATION

There is lots of information about the choir available on our website www.tottenhamcommunitychoir.org.

There is also a **WhatsApp Group** you can join, which is more for social things. All official messages come via the Comms email: <https://chat.whatsapp.com/DP6qegaHqx32VYAfPb2Kkv>

If you have any other questions, please speak to a member of the committee or your section leader, who will be happy to help. Happy singing!
